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Blog

Georgia Legislature Listened to Solar Interests with New Bill

CHAZ WILKE ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/AUTHOR/CHAZW/](https://solarmehome.com/author/CHAZW/)) / APRIL 3, 2015 ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/GEORGIA-LEGISLATURE-LISTENED-TO-SOLAR-INTERESTS-WITH-NEW-BILL/](https://solarmehome.com/georgia-legislature-listened-to-solar-interests-with-new-bill/)) / LEAVE A COMMENT ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/GEORGIA-LEGISLATURE-LISTENED-TO-SOLAR-INTERESTS-WITH-NEW-BILL/#RESPOND](https://solarmehome.com/georgia-legislature-listened-to-solar-interests-with-new-bill/#RESPOND))



You may recall our earlier reporting on the people of Georgia pushing the state's legislature (<http://bit.ly/19P102H>) for changes to the laws governing solar panels in the Peach State. And while Georgia was by no means a follower in the charge toward renewable energy, there was still some work to be done through the state's legislature.

Representative Mike Dudgeon (R) drafted legislation with the sole purpose of helping property owners with the upfront costs of installing photovoltaic solar panel systems on their homes in Georgia. Dudgeon's legislation would allow homeowners to seek third party financing for the initial costs, which previously had been illegal in Georgia.

Since the time of our last story, Dudgeon's legislation was only just emerging from drafting. Now HB 57 (<http://1.usa.gov/1Hsrti7>), as it's called, has passed both the House and Senate votes with zero opposition in both chambers and it is now heading to the governor for his signature.

Clean Technica reports (<http://bit.ly/1BYhmxL>) on the new limitations added to the bill during committee:

"The legislation did set a limit of how much electricity a residential solar installation owned by a third party can generate: 10 kilowatts. The cap was inserted into the legislation at the request of local utilities including Georgia Power, which had long claimed unrestricted solar could drive up electricity rates for the state's residents."

The bill's existence is due in part to the joint efforts of the Green Tea Coalition, which is made up of members of the state's Tea Party and the Sierra Club. Debbie Dooley, founder of the Green Tea Coalition and Conservatives for Energy recently discussed her role in shaping Georgia's solar laws. "I simply look at this as we're Americans coming together for a common purpose and a common goal," Dooley tells The Energy Gang podcast (<http://bit.ly/1MwM6Nd>).

With zero opposition in both chambers of Georgia's state Congress, it appears Dooley is correct that everyone is in fact coming together for a common goal.

Now the state waits for Georgia's governor Nathan Dean to sign the bill. It is expected he will, and by doing so will continue to push Georgia into the forefront of clean energy adoption.

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